

Contoso Ltd. -- Software Installation Procedures

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1. Overview

This document outlines the approved procedures for installing software on Contoso-managed devices. All software must be installed through approved channels. Installing unauthorized software is a violation of IT policy and may result in device quarantine.

2. Approved Installation Channels

2.1 Microsoft Intune Company Portal (Primary)

The Company Portal is the primary method for installing approved software:

- Open Company Portal from the Start menu.

- Browse or search for the application you need.

- Click Install.

- Wait for installation to complete. Most applications install within 5-10 minutes.

- If installation fails, click Retry. If it fails again, contact the IT Helpdesk.

2.2 Self-Service Software Center

For applications not available in Company Portal:

- Go to <https://itportal.contoso.com/software>.

- Sign in with your corporate credentials.

- Search for the desired software.

- Click Request. If manager approval is required, you'll receive an email once approved.

- After approval, the software will deploy to your device within 2 hours.

2.3 IT-Managed Deployment

Some specialized software requires IT to install directly:

- Database management tools (SQL Server Management Studio, Azure Data Studio)
- Development environments requiring elevated configuration
- Licensed software requiring activation key entry (CAD tools, statistical software)

Submit a ticket at <https://itportal.contoso.com/support> with the software name, business justification, and your cost center.

3. Standard Software Categories

3.1 Productivity (Auto-deployed)

These are installed automatically on all devices:

- Microsoft 365 Apps (Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook, OneNote)
- Microsoft Teams
- Microsoft Edge
- Adobe Acrobat Reader

3.2 Security (Auto-deployed, Cannot Be Removed)

- CrowdStrike Falcon (endpoint detection and response)
- Zscaler Client Connector (web security proxy)
- Microsoft Defender for Endpoint

Warning: Attempting to uninstall, disable, or tamper with security software will trigger an automatic compliance violation and your device will be quarantined within 15 minutes.

3.3 Development Tools (Available on Request)

- Visual Studio Code
- Visual Studio 2022 (Professional or Enterprise, based on license)
- Git for Windows
- Node.js (LTS version)
- Python (via Anaconda distribution)
- Docker Desktop (requires IT approval for Hyper-V enablement)
- Postman
- Azure CLI
- PowerShell 7

3.4 Design and Media (Available on Request)

- Adobe Creative Cloud (requires department budget approval)
- Figma Desktop
- Snagit (screen capture)
- Camtasia (video recording -- requires manager and IT approval)

3.5 Communication (Available on Request)

- Zoom (for external client meetings only -- Teams is the default)
- Slack (for open-source project collaboration only)
- Cisco Webex (for vendor meetings requiring Webex)

4. Installation Procedures by Application

4.1 Visual Studio Code

Open Company Portal.

Search for "Visual Studio Code."

Click Install.

After installation, open VS Code and sign in with your corporate account for Settings Sync.

Install approved extensions from the Contoso extension marketplace (<https://marketplace.contoso.com>).

4.2 Docker Desktop

Docker Desktop requires additional configuration:

Submit a software request at <https://itportal.contoso.com/software> selecting "Docker Desktop."

Business justification is required (e.g., "Containerized microservice development for Project Atlas").

IT will enable Hyper-V and WSL 2 on your device remotely.

You will receive a notification when Docker Desktop is deployed (typically within 24 hours).

After installation, configure Docker to use the Contoso container registry: contosoacr.azurecr.io.

4.3 Python (Anaconda)

Open Company Portal.

Search for "Anaconda."

Click Install.

After installation, open Anaconda Prompt and verify: `python --version`.

Configure pip to use the Contoso PyPI mirror:

```
pip config set global.index-url https://pypi.contoso.com/simple/
```

5. Software Updates

- Security patches: Applied automatically by Intune. Devices must be restarted within 48 hours of a pending security update.
- Feature updates: Deployed on a monthly cycle. You will be notified 7 days in advance.
- Third-party updates: Managed by Intune for supported applications. For unsupported applications, you are responsible for keeping them updated.

6. Prohibited Software

The following categories of software are strictly prohibited:

- Personal VPN clients (NordVPN, ExpressVPN, etc.)
- Torrent clients (uTorrent, BitTorrent, etc.)
- Remote desktop tools not approved by IT (TeamViewer, AnyDesk)
- Cryptocurrency mining software
- Cracked or pirated software of any kind
- Browser extensions not on the approved list

Installing prohibited software will result in:

Automatic device quarantine.

Notification to your manager and the IT Security team.

Potential disciplinary action per the Code of Conduct.

7. Uninstallation

To uninstall approved software:

Open Settings > Apps > Installed Apps.

Find the application and click Uninstall.

Some Intune-managed apps will reinstall automatically if they are part of your required baseline. To permanently remove, submit an exclusion request at the IT Portal.

Note: Security software (Section 3.2) cannot be uninstalled by end users.

8. Support

- IT Portal: <https://itportal.contoso.com/software>
- Email: helpdesk@contoso.com
- Phone: +1 (555) 100-2000 (Option 4 for software issues)

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